

The People Who Never Let Me Disappear



Friendship rarely announces itself.

It doesn't arrive with a grand entrance.

It doesn't ask for recognition.

Most of the time, it quietly slips into your life until one day you realize you can't remember what life felt like before it was there.



People often say that healing is a lonely journey.

I don't think mine ever was.

There were nights when I sat alone in my room.

But I was never truly by myself.

Sometimes a Discord notification appeared.

Sometimes a Messenger chat.

Sometimes a Viber message.

Sometimes someone reacted to a story on Instagram.

Sometimes it was a random comment on Facebook.

Different platforms.

Different conversations.

Different people.

The screen changed.

The feeling never did.

There was always someone on the other side.



None of them knew they were helping.

That might be the most beautiful part.

Nobody gathered around me and said,

"We're going to help Ralph heal."

Life simply continued.

Someone asked if I wanted to play.

Someone sent a meme.

Someone recommended a movie.

Someone complained about work.

Someone talked about food.

Someone disappeared for a few days, then came back as though no time had passed.

Ordinary conversations.

Ordinary people.

Ordinary days.

Looking back now...

I realize those ordinary moments quietly became extraordinary.



There were times when I joined conversations just to listen.

Times when I laughed harder than I expected.

Times when a single joke interrupted thoughts that had been weighing on me all day.

It wasn't therapy.

It wasn't advice.

It wasn't some life-changing conversation.

It was simply life refusing to stop.

And somehow...

that was exactly what I needed.



I think friendship has its own language.

It doesn't always sound like,

"I'm here for you."

Sometimes it sounds like,

"Laro?"

"Nakauwi ka na?"

"Kumain ka na?"

"Anong ginagawa mo?"

"Tara."

Tiny sentences.

Almost forgettable.

Yet somehow...

they have the strange ability to pull someone back into the world.



Looking through this journal now, I realize something.

So many pages were written after conversations with friends.

After laughing over something completely ridiculous.

After watching a movie someone suggested.

After hearing someone complain about adulting.

After talking about games.

After sharing music.

After discussing work.

None of those conversations were meant to become memories.

Yet here they are.

Scattered quietly between these pages.



The funny thing about friendship is that it rarely asks for attention.

It simply accumulates.

One message.

One laugh.

One game.

One recommendation.

One late-night conversation.

One random check-in.

Until one day you realize someone has quietly become part of your everyday life without either of you noticing exactly when it happened.



When people read this journal, they might think it was written because of heartbreak.

Part of it was.

But they might miss something else.

There were so many people who unknowingly kept reminding me that life was still moving.

That tomorrow still existed.

That laughter still sounded good.

That ordinary days were still worth living.

None of them were trying to rescue me.

They were simply being themselves.

Sometimes...

that's the greatest gift anyone can give another person.



If I've learned anything through all of this, it's that no one becomes themselves alone.

Every person who made me laugh.

Every person who listened.

Every person who invited me into a conversation.

Every person who stayed.

Whether for years...

or only for a season...

left something behind.

Maybe they don't even know it.

Maybe they never will.

But I do.

And this chapter exists because of that.



So if you're reading these pages and wondering whether you were one of those people...

You probably were.

More than you'll ever know.



— Ralph.

